According to De Roover, what helped the Church in making a case for its freedom from all forms of secular dominion was the fact that the separation of the spiritual and the secular ‘was essential to Christianity itself and its understanding of human existence from the very beginning’. In fact, the distinction was traceable to a combined reading of specific chapters and verses of the King James Bible, namely John 18:36 (‘My kingdom is not of this world’), Luke 20:20 and Mark 12:17 (‘Render to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s, and to God the things that are God’s’). What is to be discerned from this history is that the distinction between the secular and the spiritual was drawn from *within* the Christian framework and not outside of it. The sum and substance of the distinction was elaborated as follows by Hugh of Saint Victor in *De Sacramentis Christinae Fidei*:

> There are two lives, one earthly, the other heavenly, one corporeal, the other spiritual. By one the body lives from the soul, by the other the soul lives from God. Each has its own good by which it is invigorated and nourished so that it can subsist. The earthly life is nourished with earthly goods, the spiritual life with spiritual goods. To the earthly life belong all things that are earthly, to the spiritual life all goods that are spiritual . … Among laymen, to whose zeal and forethought the things that are necessary for earthly life pertain, the power is earthly. Among the clergy, to whose office the goods of the spiritual life belong, the power is divine. The one power is therefore called secular, the other spiritual.[10]

Clearly, the divide between the spiritual and the secular was not outside the scope of Christian OET.[11] In fact, De Roover categorically states that ‘without the support of a cluster of Christian-theological notions—soul and body, the earthly and spiritual life, divine power and the kingdom of Christ, and so on—this distinction would dissolve into thin air’.[12] Consequently, neither term, spiritual nor secular, when used in the context of contemporary nation-states must be divorced from the Christian origins in which they are embedded.[13] De Roover goes as far as to say that the metes and bounds of the spiritual and secular realms were determined on the basis of Christian OET over which the Roman Catholic Church had the final word.